

HOW I HAVE HURT OTHERS

GOALS OF THE EXERCISE

1. Acknowledge hurtful behavior toward others.
2. Identify specific behaviors that have been engaged in to hurt others.
3. Identify the consequences of hurtful behavior.
4. Describe ways to make amends for hurtful behavior.

ADDITIONAL PROBLEMS FOR WHICH THIS EXERCISE MAY BE MOST USEFUL

- Anger Management
- Chemical Dependence
- Chemical Dependence—Relapse
- Legal Conflicts

SUGGESTIONS FOR PROCESSING THIS EXERCISE WITH THE CLIENT

Minimization and denial are traits that often accompany antisocial behavior patterns. This exercise is designed to increase sensitivity to antisocial behaviors that cause others pain. Confrontation may be necessary to bring the client to acknowledge behaviors that are not included in his/her checklist. Be alert to the antisocial personality trait of projection, that is, the client may try to place blame for his/her behavior on anyone but himself/herself. Role reversal may be necessary to help the client feel the pain of his/her behavior on others.

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We are capable of hurting others in many different ways. This assignment will help you become more aware of various behaviors that have a hurtful impact on others. Sometimes we are very aware that we are hurting someone with our behavior, while at other times, we do not even seem to notice it. Review the list of hurtful behaviors that follow and put a checkmark next to those that you have engaged in and that have resulted in pain for others.

Hurtful Behaviors

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Dishonesty | ☐ Sex abuse |
| ☐ Disloyalty | ☐ Unfaithfulness |
| ☐ Physically assaultive | ☐ Verbal attacks |
| ☐ Stealing | ☐ Irresponsibility |
| ☐ Unkindness | ☐ Insensitivity |
| ☐ Blaming | ☐ Threatening |
| ☐ Illegal acts | ☐ Weapon use |
| ☐ Substance abuse | ☐ Name calling |
| ☐ Job loss | ☐ Unkept promises |

1. Describe three situations where you have hurt others through engaging in one of the behaviors listed.

Situation A: _____

Situation B: _____

Situation C: _____

2. Describe how your behavior affected others. How were they hurt?

Situation A: _____

Situation B: _____

Situation C: _____

3. What might you do to make amends for your hurtful behavior toward others in these three situations?

Situation A: _____

Situation B: _____

Situation C: _____
